

Q.2b (15 marks): Total institution - preserving sense of self

अपनी आत्म-भावना को किस प्रकार संरक्षित रखने का प्रयास करते हैं।

What is 'total institution'? Explaining its characteristics, comment on how individuals attempt to preserve their sense of self within such environments.

15

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नहीं लिखना
चाहिए
Candidates
must not
write on
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Erwin Goffman put forward the concept of Total Institutions in his essay "Total institution: essay on social situation of asylum inmates".

Total Institutions

Places where individual is cut off from the outside world, strip off from earlier identity & under constant supervision of officials.

Examples

Asylums
Orphanages
Training academies
~~Military~~ ~~Boarding~~ School

Characteristics

① Existence of dominant-subservient

Relationships

- ② Uniform world with limited individuality
- ③ Existence of a bureaucracy for management
- ④ Cut off from outside world
- ⑤ Reshaping the idea of self by degradation ceremony
- ⑥ Strict timeline & procedure for daily activities

Individual attempt to preserve sense of self

- ① Belongings from earlier life, like clothes, photos are preserved
- ② Diary writing to maintain sense of individuality
- ③ Pursuit of hobbies like physical exercise, music, etc

④ Periodic visits from relations outside the institution

⑤ Cultivation of relationship within the institution

Current Relevance

a) Emergence of new form of total institution: Quarantine Camps post Covid.

Criticism

a) Goffman overemphasise on coercive nature of institutions overlooking subtle process

~~These~~ Despite criticism it provide us understand